REMOTE ACCESS

WyIT - 3017

PURPOSE: This policy defines requirements for connecting to the state's internal network(s) from external hosts via remote access technology and/or for utilizing the Internet for business purposes via affiliate ISP devices.

To protect state resources from unauthorized use and/or malicious attack, all remote access privileges to enterprise resources must employ state-approved methods. Any applicable affiliate utilizing remote access privileges is responsible for ensuring remote access connections remain as secure as the network access within a state government facility. It is imperative that any remote access connection used to conduct state business be utilized appropriately, responsibly, and ethically.

I. APPLICABILITY

This policy applies to all Executive Branch agencies, boards, and commissions staff (collectively referred to as "agencies"). This policy is also applicable to consultants, affiliates, and temporary employees.

II. DEFINITIONS

All definitions for this policy are located in the Policy Dictionary.

III. EXCEPTIONS

Any exceptions provided to the following policy must abide by the WyIT - 3002 - Security Exception Request.

IV. ACCESSING AND SECURING STATE-OWNED EQUIPMENT

All state-owned equipment must be:

- Accessed only by state employees for remote and/or telework access on the state network.
- Connected to the state network for asset inventory management, security vulnerability scanning, patch management, and maintenance, Monday – Saturday, 6 am – 6 pm.
- Physically secured from all physical and environmental threats.
- Regularly updated with the CIO approved endpoint and enterprise security solution(s).
- Reported immediately to a manager and the CIO Service Desk if damaged, lost, or stolen.

V. AUTHORIZED AFFILIATE & CONTRACTOR EQUIPMENT

All authorized affiliate and contractor-owned equipment and devices must:

- Be physically secured from any unauthorized use and access. Verification and validation of physical security controls will be provided to the CIO annually and/or when a significant change to the environment has occurred.
- Have CIO approved endpoint and enterprise security solution(s).

VI. REMOTE CONNECTIONS

- Employees, contractors, affiliates, and temporary staff may be permitted to remotely access the state network while offsite. Users must use the approved Virtual Private Network (VPN) service(s). Users will be required to authenticate using multifactor authentication (MFA). Only authorized users are permitted to access the network through a VPN. Users attempting to connect to the State domain using an unapproved access solution will be denied access.
- Remote state employees using a public ISP from an authorized telework location must employ the state-provided and approved method of connecting, which must be made through managed points of entry and reviewed by the security liaison. When approved solutions are not appropriate due to connectivity limitations, a secondary solution can be authorized.
- Remote connections (i.e., hotspots, etc.) configured to access state resources must adhere to all applicable State policies. Prior approval for any remote access connection must be provided by the CIO. In addition, all hardware security configurations must be approved by the CIO. An assessment must be performed and documented to determine the scope and method of access, the

technical and business risks involved, and the contractual, process, and technical controls required for such connection to take place.

- Working from a remote location must be authorized by management and practices that ensure the appropriate protection of data in remote environments must be shared with the individual prior to the individual being granted remote access.
- Employees, contractors, affiliates, and temporary staff will make no modifications to the remote access connection without express approval by the CIO. This includes but is not limited to, split tunneling, dual homing, non-standard hardware, or security configurations.
- Employees, contractors, affiliates, and temporary staff with remote access privileges must ensure that their computers are not connected to any other network while connected to the state network, with the exception of internet connectivity.
- No employee may use internet access through company networks via remote connection for the purpose of illegal transactions, harassment, competitor interests, or obscene behavior in accordance with other existing employee policies.
- Unless coordinated, remote access sessions timeout after 45 minutes of inactivity and will terminate after 9 hours of continuous connection. Both timeouts will require the user to reconnect and re-authenticate in order to re-enter the state network.

VII. USER AGREEMENTS

Remote access affiliates agree:

- To immediately report to their manager and the CIO any incident or suspected incident of unauthorized access and/or disclosure of State resources, databases, networks, etc.
- To accept that access and/or connection to the state's network(s) may be monitored to record dates, times, and duration of access to identify unusual usage patterns or other activity. As with computers physically residing in a state government facility, this is done to identify accounts/computers that may have been compromised by external parties.

REFERENCES: This policy has no supporting references to websites, other policies, or federal or state statutes.

DOCUMENT HISTORY

ORIGINAL SUBMISSION				
SUBMITTED ON	**SUBMITTED BY**	**APPROVED BY**	**APPROVED BY DATE(S)**	**EFFECTIVE DATE**
June 2024	ETS Governance, Risk and Compliance	Public Comment Period	05/10/2024 - 05/24/2024	June 2024

REVISIONS		
LAST REVISION DATE	**LAST REVISED BY**	**LAST APPROVED BY**

REVIEWS		
LAST REVIEW DATE	**LAST REVIEWED BY**	**NEXT REVIEW DATE**